

# **GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT**

## **OFFICIAL MINUTES — WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 2, 2026**

The Grimes County Commissioners Court met on Wednesday, September 2, 2026, at 8:30 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox.

County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order.

### **Call to Order**

Grimes County Judge - Joe Fauth III

County Judge Joe Fauth opened the public hearing on the Grimes County 2026-2027 proposed budget and noted that Commissioner Mallett was absent but a quorum was present. The judge invited public comments and received remarks from three citizens.

### **Public Hearing**

#### **1 Consider and hear public comments regarding the Grimes County 2026/2027 proposed budget, pursuant to Texas Local Government Code, Chapter 111, Section 111.007.**

Pursuant to Texas Local Government Code, Chapter 111, Section 111.007.

County Judge Joe Fauth opened the public hearing on the Grimes County 2026/2027 proposed budget and invited comments from citizens. Debra Morwood noted positive steps including the addition of a fire marshal position and increased investment in fire protection, emergency management, and ambulances, but raised concerns about whether the county was planning far enough ahead for industrial growth. She asked whether the fire marshal had conducted a long-range assessment of needed infrastructure such as hydrants, fire flow capacity, water storage, and staffing, and whether any of the budgeted ambulances were intended for the ambulance bay required under the SpaceX tax abatement agreement. Karen Shiver expressed appreciation for changes to the election office and continued support for libraries and food banks, and suggested the court develop a salary increase formula that prioritizes lower-paid workers over higher earners rather than giving percentage raises across the board. Marie Egyed, representing the Grimes County Citizens for Responsible Development, acknowledged the budget's increased funding for road materials and bridge work but expressed concern that staffing levels in development management, permitting, inspections, and 911 services were not increasing proportionally to handle the anticipated economic growth from major industrial projects; she also raised frustration that the current budget posted online differed from what the court was considering, preventing meaningful public comment. County Judge Fauth responded to several points: he confirmed the court's intent to hire a dedicated fire marshal and explained the September 16 meeting was planned for the final budget vote; he noted the court had proposed raising the minimum salary to twenty dollars per hour; he addressed ambulance procurement, explaining that four new ambulances ordered would eventually replace aging high-mileage units and that TeraFab would provide its own ambulance at its facility; and he discussed the timing of TeraFab payments, clarifying that an early \$10 million payment in 2027 would help fund needed personnel and materials. County Attorney Megan Barcak explained that the budget posted online was the version approved on August 14 per statutory requirement and that subsequent revisions made in public meetings had not been reposted pending finalization by the auditor's office. Karen Shiver added a personal account of a recent death in Bedias that highlighted ambulance availability concerns and expressed the need for additional ambulances, to which the judge responded by explaining county mutual aid agreements with Bryan-College Station and

Madisonville, discussing potential state assistance for ambulances serving the geriatric prison unit, and noting the significant geographic challenge of serving a county spanning forty-seven miles north to south.

**Signature**

Joe Fauth III, Grimes County Judge

DATED: 08/19/2026

**ADJOURN**

---

**Motion to Adjourn by Michael Raska and seconded by Joe Fauth. Carried (4-0-0).**

**(adjourn 8:58 AM)**

*THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT ON September 2nd, 2026, ARE HEREBY APPROVED.*

---

Barbara Kimich County Clerk